Trivandrum. The inspector went here and asked for Mariam's passport and other documents. Now, he found that her visa had expired on 14 October 1994.

After several cross examinations and perusal of documents, the court found many of pieces of evidence against Mariam inadmissible. What is more, it clearly pointed a finger at inspector Vijayan for the way in which he arrested Mariam. The judgment said:

'A careful scrutiny of the evidence as a whole reveals that the accused was arrested by PW2 (Vijayan) suspecting espionage activities on her … air tickets were recovered by PW2 with his full knowledge for the purpose of arresting the accused on the ground of her overstay in India. As she had obtained air tickets for her return journey within the permissible period, there was no necessity for her to apply for extension of her stay in India. In fact she was chased by the police party consisting of PW2 and others at least from the middle of October, 1994, obstructing her from leaving India.'

The court acquitted Mariam Rasheeda.

For me, this case marked the first victory for another reason. It was during this trial that the first definite statement from the CBI came that the spy case was false.

From the judgment: 'During the course of argument, the learned senior special prosecutor submitted that in investigation the espionage case was found false and baseless and that the CBI is going to file refer report in the connected case …'